Identified Artificial intelligence

Vitality AI (Personal Health Pathways)

An evolution of the Vitality behavior-change platform with a centralized data and coding stack powering hyper-personalization and automation that combines clinical, lifestyle,eee, and behavioral data to enhance risk prediction

Evolved the Shared-value model by leveraging data and technology assets in developing the Vitality AI platform, which will power hyper-personalized experiences and enable a more precise understanding of clients' health risks and related actions to improve health outcomes

Since its launch in January 2025, Personal Health Pathways has achieved over 300,000 activations, which demonstrates the strong forward momentum of the Vitality AI-powered platform. (integrated report, 2025)

Discovery AI

Discovery AI provides a personalized banking experience by analyzing clients' spending and saving patterns, helping them understand how their accounts work, and offering insights and recommendations to maximize account features and rewards.

Discovery made key updates to its digital servicing capabilities in the financial year 2025, including introducing an AI-powered client-servicing feature for call center bankers and developing Discovery AI for clients, both of which are expected to yield financial benefits and enhance the client experience. (Integrated Financial Report, 2025).

AI that could be implemented:

AI that could be implemented:

Target sector (IR2025)

Healthcare, Banking, and Insurance

Discovery main threat/risk

Cybercrime and data breaches

Information risk, disruptive technology risk, and cybercrime are all in the top 5 of the Discovery risk assessment.

Recommended artificial intelligence:

Microsoft defender extended detention and response (xdr)

Microsoft product powered by a combination of AI tools and machine learning to proactively detect cyber-attacks (Microsoft Defender Suite, 2026)

Integrates multiple security tools to detect, prevent, and automatically respond to cyber threats, protecting endpoints, email, and user identities.

Partnering with Microsoft provides Discovery with advanced AI and machine learning capabilities to proactively identify and respond to evolving cyber threats.

Discovery AI adoption against competitors and industry leaders.

Discovery adopted artificial intelligence at an early stage and has successfully integrated it across its operations. It uses predictive AI and machine learning through tools such as Personal Health Pathways (Vitality AI) in Discovery Health, conversational AI for banking services, and AI-powered insurance quoting. Through its global Vitality platform, Discovery has expanded its AI capabilities internationally.

Compared with competitors such as Sanlam, which mainly uses AI for data analysis, trend prediction, and operational efficiency, Discovery has gone further by developing and commercializing an AI-powered platform for other organizations. As a result, Discovery is one of South Africa's leading AI adopters, while UnitedHealth Group is regarded as a global leader in AI innovation and a key international competitor.

Recommend improvements.

According to the Discovery Integrated Report (2025), the Personal Health Pathways platform incurred minimal losses from delayed or non-materializing revenue contracts.

Given the issue of incurring product introduction losses, improvements that could be done is that Discovery should investigate the main reason for delays and ensure that the product personal health pathway, is well details and made known to customers through different platform such as advertising on social media and television together with steps of usage and benefits to raise awareness, therefore, Discovery should improve marketing segment of the product personal health pathway.

Governance and ethical implications of AI adoption

Responsible AI Adoption Forum is a forum dedicated to AI adoption that ensures good governance, regulatory alignment, and the responsible and ethical use of AI.

Discovery strives for effective management of data privacy, security, technology, and cyber risk, practices that strengthen and mature its cybersecurity measures to protect against emerging threats and ensure compliance with data privacy regulations, safeguarding information assets. Their practices align with the South African national AI policy framework (Integrated Annual Report 2024)

3.5 Financial reporting and assurance benefits and risks

AI will ensure consistency and improved financial accuracy and efficiency in financial reporting. AI can identify irregularities and mismatches between related information, thereby enabling fraud detection or data manipulation. Improved financial information integrity.

The first risk of AI adoption is the inability to integrate with the entity's operation. Discovery integrated its AI very efficiently and effectively into its sectors and operations. The potential risk is now overreliance on AI. Although Discovery provides AI training to employees, some may become overly reliant on AI rather than using it as a support tool. This could reduce professional judgment, accountability, and the reliability of financial reporting and assurance.